

Alexa Tarrayo

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Communications and visual design professional with over 6 years working primarily in the non-profit sector. I specialize in working with groups vested in community engagement, social impact and advocacy, accessibility and education. I've led and implemented full organizational rebrands, created full communications and branding packages, managed social media and newsletter channels, designed websites, and created print and digital marketing collateral. I come with a breadth of skills that honour my dual degree in Communication and Design.

Work Experience

Communications Lead | PeerNetBC | 2019 - Present

- Own social media channels from end to end, including developing a monthly newsletter distributed through Mailchimp and crossposting content to the website. This process includes: social listening, keeping a content schedule, monitoring engagement and using analytics to refine strategy, copywriting, and the illustration and design of graphics and other promotional material using the Adobe Suite and Canva.
- Led a full organization rebrand grounded in staff collaboration to collect data: gathered community input through interviews, interactive surveys, and delivered tailored weekly workshops to a diverse set of learning styles, incorporating feedback on revising PeerNetBC's identity.
- Redesigned and rewrote (for SEO) the 2002 PeerNetBC website, ensuring alignment with PeerNetBC's new brand identity to reflect changes in core values. Collaborated with developer to migrate to Wordpress.
- Established clear design principles and sustainability processes at PeerNetBC by creating a robust communications package with brand guidelines and key messaging influencing our team onboarding and sponsorship fundraising package.
- Responsible for the design and execution of all PeerNetBC assets such as posters, social media and website graphics, brochures, reports, workshop presentations, and worksheets for print and digital.

Organizational Strategy and Operations Co-Lead | PeerNetBC | 2022 - Present

- Beyond communications, taken on a broad operational lead role, leading grant writing and funder reporting, supporting hiring, overseeing tech procurement, and building the project management infrastructure.
- Facilitated weekly strategy meetings to evaluate PeerNetBC's mandate alignment, driving a complete revision of mission, vision, and values that directly influence the direction of fundraising, strategic planning, organizational voice, and branding.
- Manage grant writing and reporting for multiple core funders including City of Vancouver (\$50K), BC Gaming (\$147K), and Vancouver Foundation's Level BIPOC Grant (\$150K), etc.
- Acted as project manager across teams: tracking deadlines, project milestones, and content calendars.

Communications and Design Assistant | Kinsight | 2018 - 2019

- Communications and design assistant for a non-profit serving people with physical and mental disabilities. Kinsight provides services such as assisted living, supported employment opportunities, and play centres for children with developmental delays and disabilities.
- Implemented the Kinsight rebrand from the Simon Fraser Society for Community Living by redesigning core organizational documents like brochures, information sheets, and infographics.
- Responsible for the content (event photography, interviews, design) and distribution of monthly "Spotlight," a Kinsight-wide employee-focused e-bulletin.
- *Retained as a contractor from 2019 - 2025* to design print and digital assets to support ongoing communications. This includes a yearly annual report, event photography, posters, and brochures.

Work Experience Cont.

Social Media and Design Assistant | Scentuals Natural & Organic Skincare | 2019

- Managed social media content and scheduling using Hootsuite and Later.com, working alongside Langton PR on brand growth strategy for Scentuals and a new wholesale sister brand.
- Supported the Design Lead on the branding of a new sister brand by leading product photography.
- Designed labels, packaging, and sell sheets across multiple product collections.
- Wrote SEO-optimized blog posts and newsletters in collaboration with the marketing team.

Freelance and Community

Contract Designer | Fresh Roots Urban Farm Society | 2021 - 2023

- Designed print and website graphic collateral for a non-profit working with youth and school communities on food education, land and farming, and creating sustainable ecosystems.
- Designed Fresh Roots' Annual Reports for print and digital distribution working directly with the Communications Director.
- Supported with event and portrait photography for social media and internal image libraries.

Organizer, Designer & Social Media | Glued: BIPoC Zine & Art Fair

- Co-created and ran a community market uplifting BIPoC artists in Vancouver's local zine and printmaking scene. Created posters, social media templates, and merchandise.

Articles: Music & Concert Reviews | The Permanent Rain Press (PR Press)

- Wrote music reviews for singles, albums, and concerts for local and upcoming artists in British Columbia and Canada. The PR Press is a POC woman-run Vancouver-based music news and interview outlet, highlighting up and coming musicians, artists and actors.

Education

Simon Fraser University

Bachelor of Arts

Joint Major: Communications and Interactive Arts + Technology

Certifications

University of British Columbia

Writing for the Web and Digital Media

Simon Fraser University

Creative Fiction for the Weekend Student

Technical Skills

Design & Content: Adobe Illustrator, InDesign, Photoshop, Lightroom, Premiere, Canva, Canva Affinity, Figma.

Web & Digital: WordPress, Wix, Mailchimp, Constant Contact, Eventbrite.

Social Media: Meta (Facebook, Instagram), Meta Advertising, Hootsuite, Later, Google Analytics.

Operations & Collaboration: Notion, Monday.com, Miro, Google for Nonprofits, Microsoft Suite.

Photography: Event, portrait, and product photography.